

OrchidApp

Recover OrchidApp after machine failure

Step-by-step restore guide for a new or repaired Windows computer

Applies to: Windows 11 and a previous OrchidApp backup saved to a cloud-synced folder such as OneDrive, Google Drive or iCloud Drive.

Purpose

Use this guide when the old computer has failed, been replaced or been reinstalled, and you need to restore OrchidApp on a new Windows computer.

The safest recovery route is to install OrchidApp again, sign in to the cloud provider that holds the backup, then restore the latest OrchidApp backup ZIP from that cloud folder.

Start here: Follow the [Install OrchidApp on Windows](#) guide first. Install OrchidApp and create the desktop or Start menu shortcut before starting the restore steps in this guide.

Before you start

- Install OrchidApp on the new computer using the normal Windows install guide.
- Sign in to the cloud service that contains the OrchidApp backup folder.
- Wait until the backup file has synced to the new computer.
- Use the OrchidApp backup ZIP.
- Close the OrchidApp browser tab before restoring. Leave the OrchidApp Launcher window open.

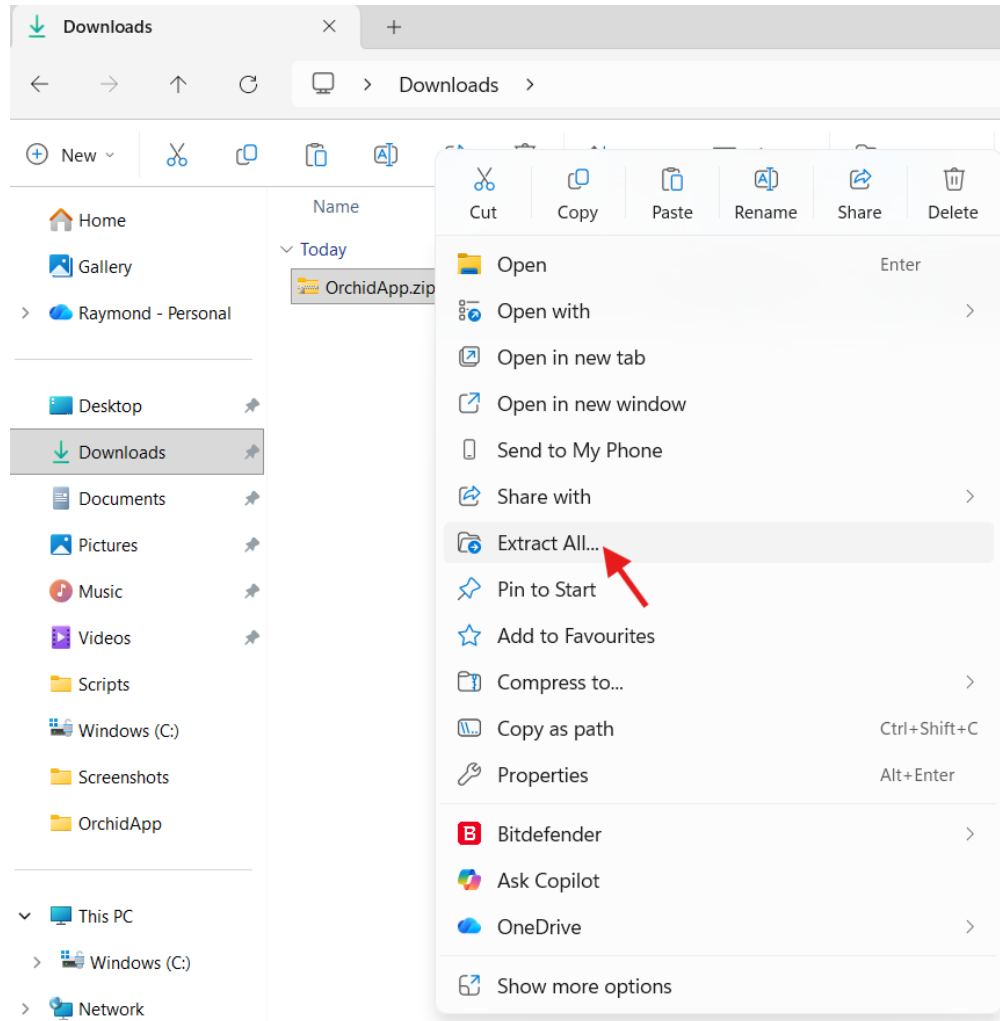
Quick checklist

1. Install OrchidApp on the new computer.
2. Open OrchidApp once so the launcher starts.
3. Close the browser tab, but keep the launcher open.
4. Optional but recommended: configure the cloud backup folder again.
5. Click Restore from backup.
6. Choose the OrchidAppDataBackup.zip file from the cloud backup folder.
7. Confirm the restore warning.
8. Wait for Restore completed successfully.
9. Close and reopen OrchidApp.

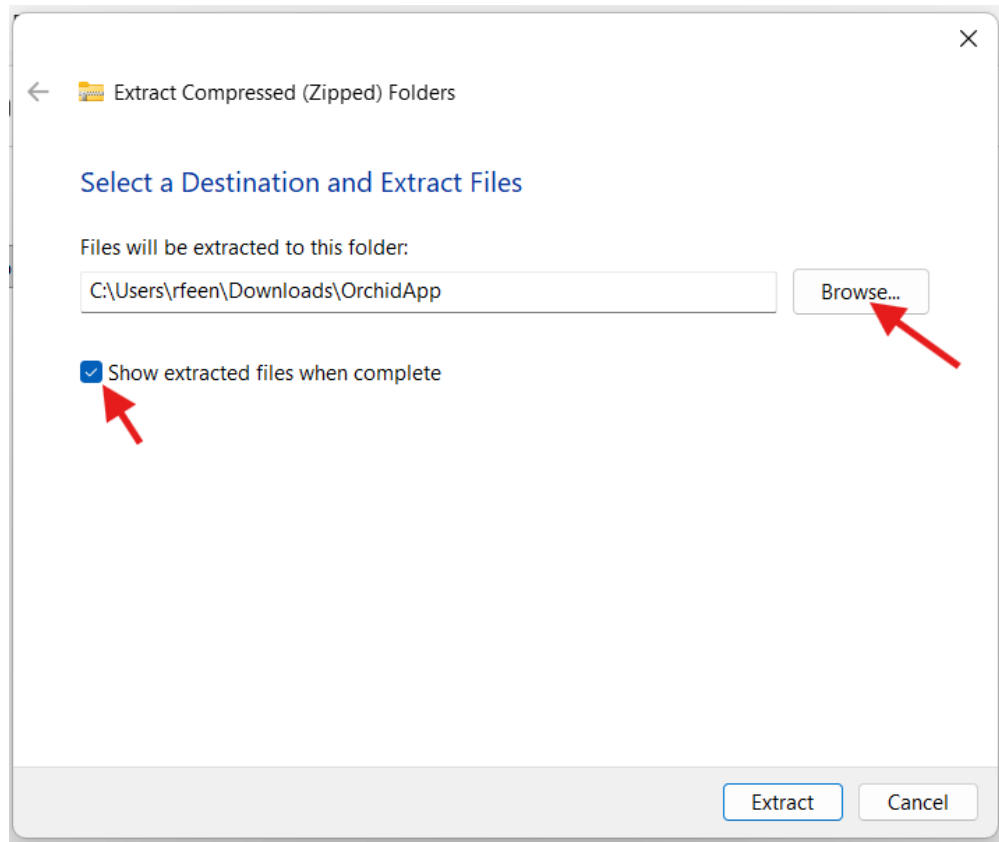
Step-by-step recovery

1. Install OrchidApp on the new computer

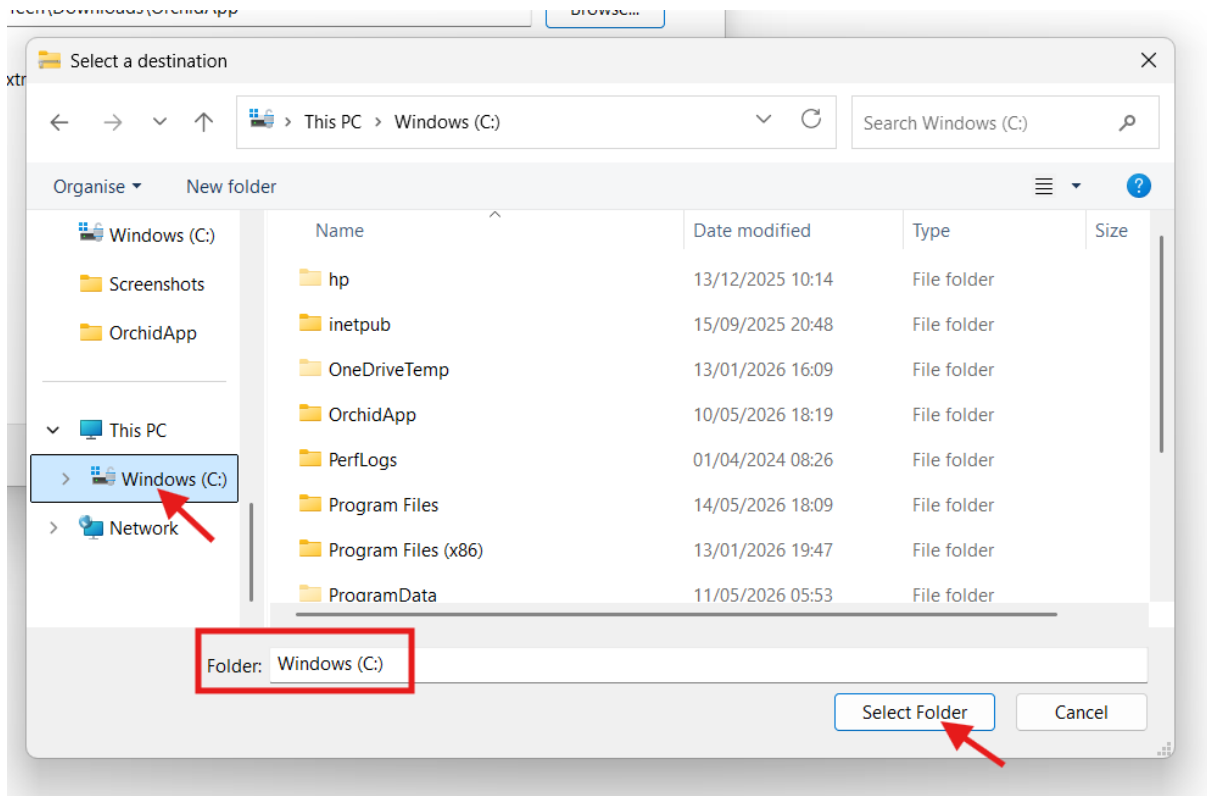
Begin with the [Install OrchidApp on Windows](#) guide. Download or copy the OrchidApp ZIP file to the new computer, then extract it to a permanent folder. The screenshots below show the key installation points, but the install guide remains the main reference.



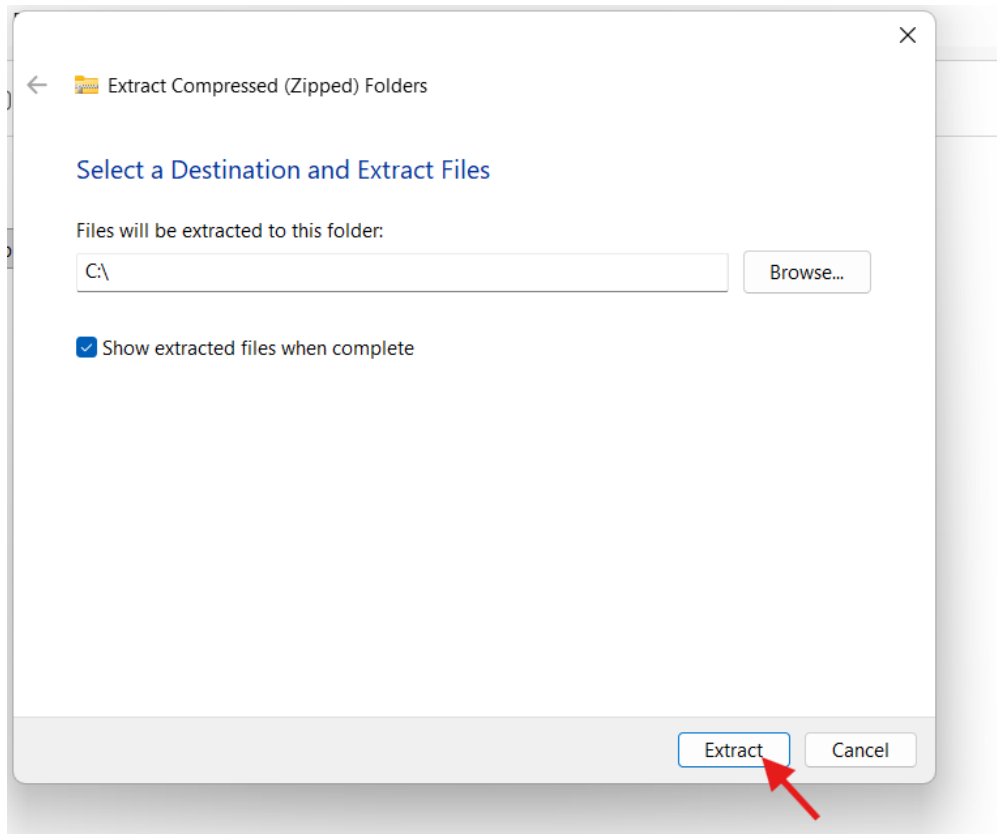
Right-click OrchidApp.zip and choose Extract All...



Use Browse if you want to choose a different installation folder.



Choose a permanent location for OrchidApp, such as C:\OrchidApp or a folder under Documents.



Leave Show extracted files when complete ticked, then choose Extract.

2. Start OrchidApp and bring the launcher to the front

After installation, start OrchidApp from the desktop shortcut or Start menu. OrchidApp opens in the browser and the OrchidApp Launcher stays open on the taskbar.



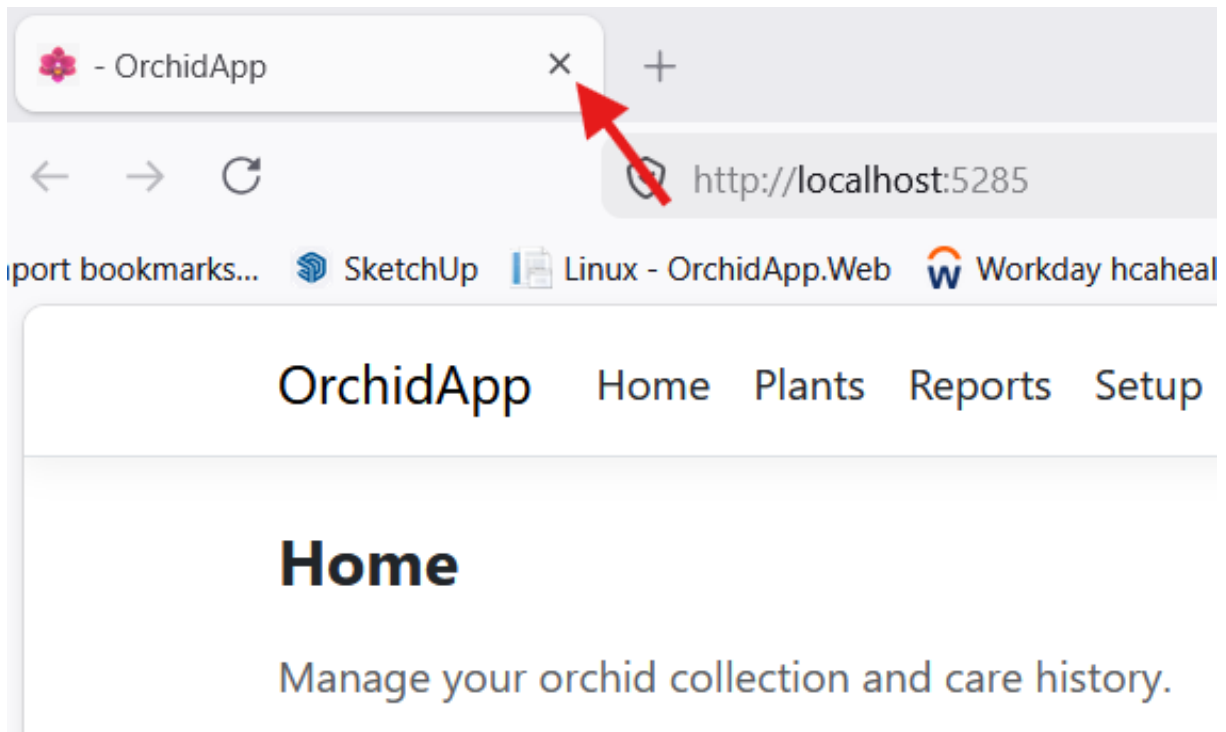
Select the OrchidApp Launcher icon on the taskbar if the launcher is behind another window.



Bring the OrchidApp Launcher to the front.

3. Close the browser tab before restoring

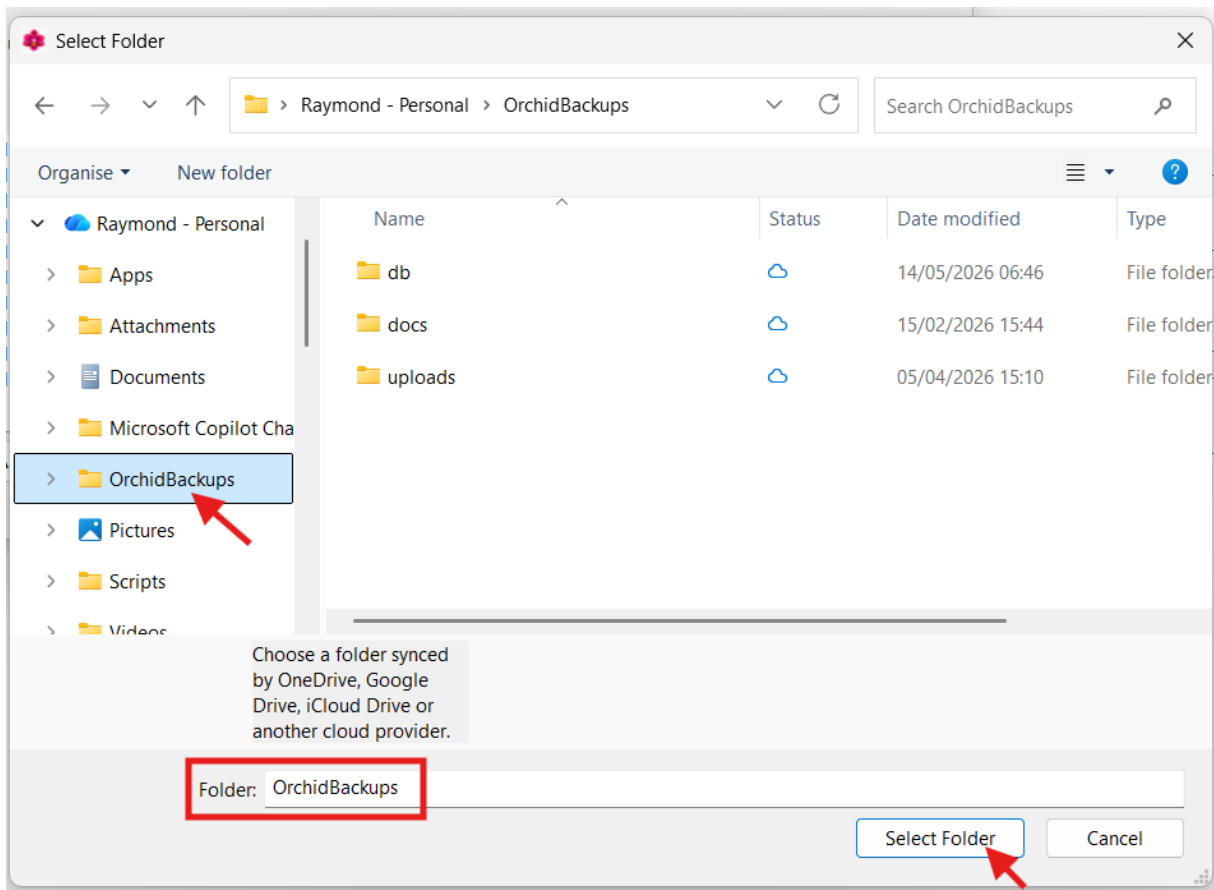
Close the OrchidApp browser tab before restoring. This helps make sure the database and uploaded files can be safely replaced. Do not close the OrchidApp Launcher window.



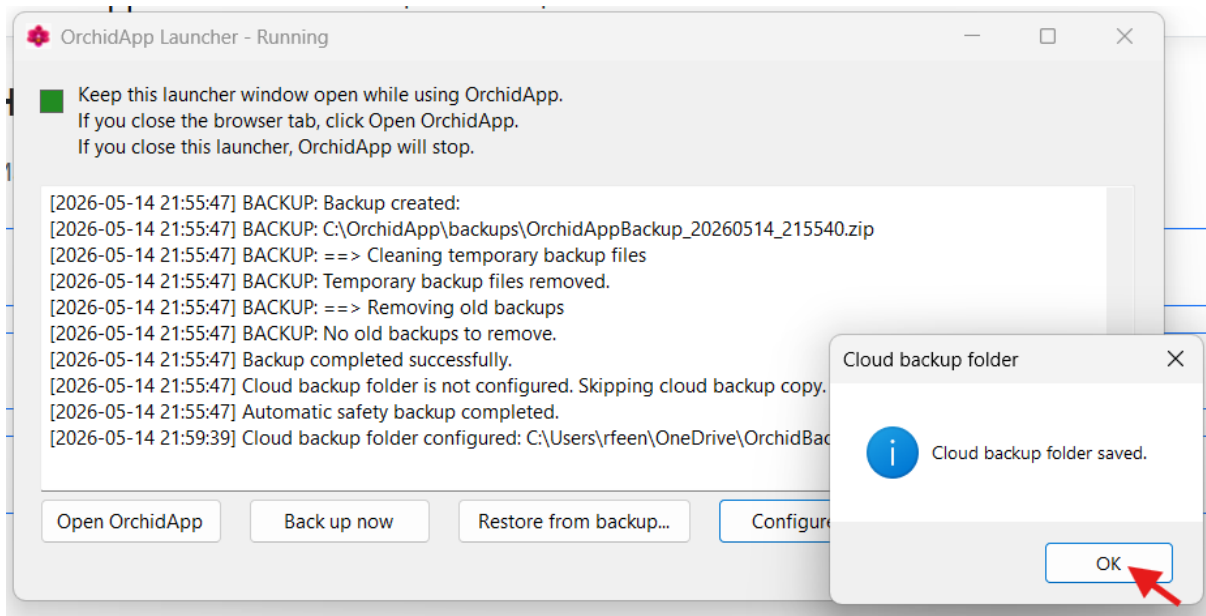
Close the OrchidApp browser tab. Leave the launcher window open.

4. Optional: configure the cloud backup folder on the new computer

If this is a new computer, configure the cloud backup folder again after the cloud provider has synced the backup folder locally. This does not perform the restore by itself, but it prepares OrchidApp to keep saving future safety copies after recovery.



Select the folder that is synced by OneDrive, Google Drive, iCloud Drive or another cloud provider.



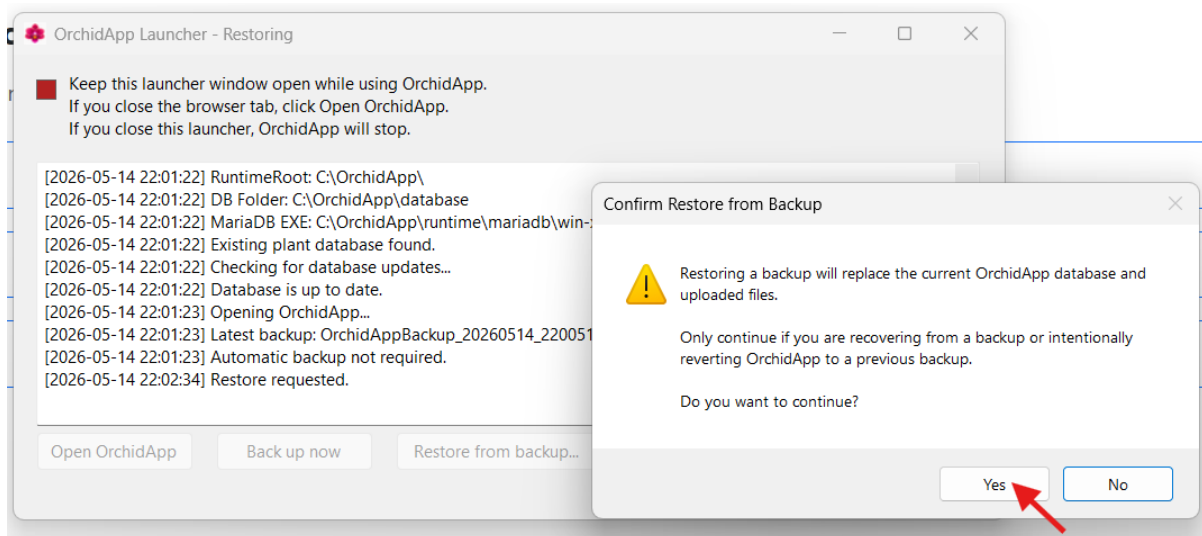
OrchidApp confirms that the cloud backup folder has been saved.

5. Start the restore

In the OrchidApp Launcher, choose Restore from backup. This starts the recovery process.

7. Confirm the restore warning

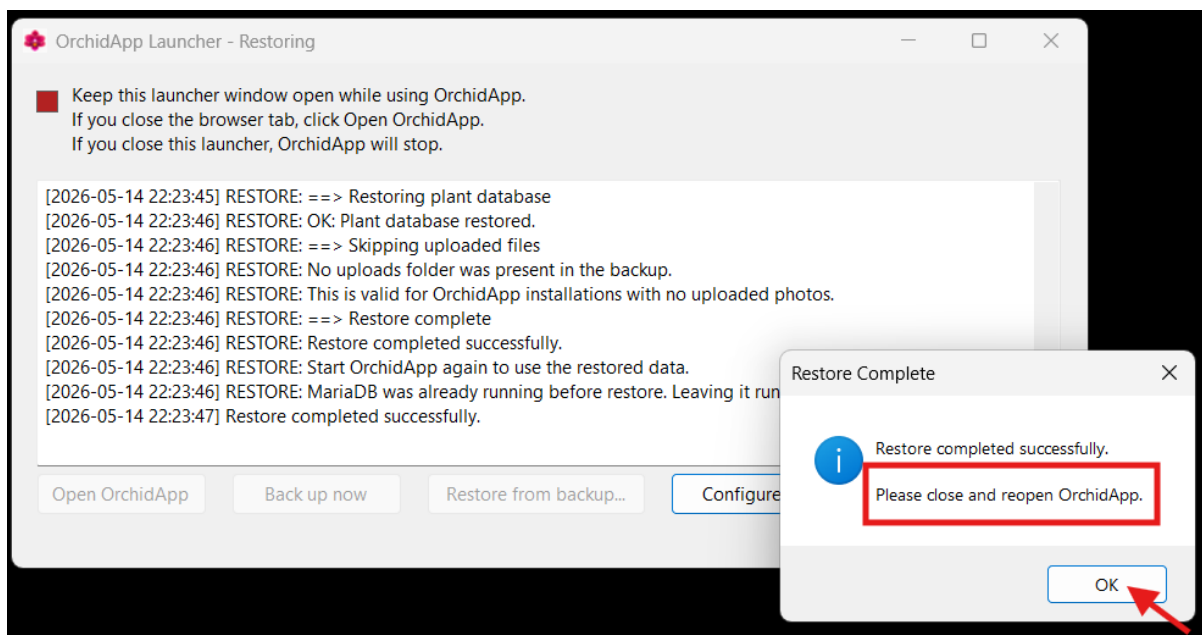
OrchidApp warns that restoring a backup will replace the current OrchidApp database and uploaded files. Continue only when you are sure you have selected the correct backup file.



Choose Yes only when you are ready to replace the current OrchidApp data with the selected backup.

8. Wait for the restore to complete

Wait until OrchidApp reports that the restore completed successfully. Do not close the launcher while the restore is running.



When the restore is complete, choose OK. Then close and reopen OrchidApp.

9. Reopen OrchidApp and check your data

Close OrchidApp fully, then open it again from the desktop shortcut or Start menu. Check that your plants, photos, locations, growth media and history are present.

If anything looks wrong, do not add new data immediately. Close OrchidApp and restore again from the correct backup file.

What the restore brings back

Restored item	What this means
Plant records	Plant names, Plant Tags, acquisition details and active or ended plant status.
Setup data	Plant groups, species / hybrids, locations and growth media.
Plant history	Observations, movements, flowering, repotting, splitting, propagation and heritage.
Uploaded files	Plant photos and other uploaded files, if they were present in the backup.

Important safety notes

- Restoring replaces the OrchidApp data currently on the computer.
- Only restore from a backup you trust.
- Keep the OrchidApp backup ZIP in a folder that is synced by your cloud provider.
- After recovery, configure cloud backup again so future backups are copied to the cloud folder.
- Do not edit or unpack the backup ZIP manually.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
I cannot find the backup file	Check that you are signed in to the correct cloud account and that the cloud folder has finished syncing.
The Restore from backup button is unavailable	Close the OrchidApp browser tab and wait for the launcher to return to the normal Running state.
The restore completed but photos are missing	Check that the backup selected was the complete OrchidApp backup ZIP and not a partial or manually edited file.
I selected the wrong backup	Restore again using the correct backup file. Do this before adding new information.
The app does not open after restore	Close OrchidApp fully, reopen it from the shortcut and check the launcher messages. If needed, restore again from the latest trusted backup.

Recovery complete: When OrchidApp opens and your plant records are visible, the recovery is complete. Keep the cloud backup folder configured so the next backup is copied to the cloud automatically.